

VERLYN TECH

UAE Market Entry, Services, Pricing and Pitch Strategy

Growth systems for UAE SMEs: CRM, landing pages and SEO, paid ads, lead generation, agentic AI and automation.

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Verlyn does not sell "AI". It installs operational systems that answer leads faster, drop fewer customers and remove manual admin, and it proves each one with the client's own numbers before asking for more money.

1. The market signal and what we sell

The gap. Small and medium enterprises make up 94% of all UAE businesses, yet only 8% have reached advanced digital maturity. Enterprise AI spending in the UAE rose 105% year over year, but execution lags: most businesses want automation and lack the budget and in-house skills to implement it. The biggest SME barriers are setup cost and skills gaps, not lack of interest. Cheap, fast, done-for-you execution beats an expensive consultant and beats an owner trying to DIY it.

Recommended direction

A practical growth-systems agency for SMEs. Not a pure marketing agency, not a pure dev shop, and never pitched as an "AI agency". Verlyn installs the systems, automation and marketing that move real revenue for businesses too small to hire an in-house team or afford a big agency.

The product is an outcome, not AI

Nobody buys AI. They buy faster lead response, fewer dropped customers, less admin time and cleaner data for decisions. AI and automation are the mechanism, not the pitch.

Language to avoid	Language that works
AI-powered, cutting-edge, game-changing, leverage synergies, revolutionize, disrupt, next-gen, unlock the power of AI, seamless AI integration. If a sentence could appear on a thousand other agency sites, cut it.	Specific and numbers-first. "Your leads get answered in under 2 minutes instead of 2 days." "We turned 40% of your Instagram DMs into booked appointments automatically." "Your team stops copying invoice data by hand; it is matched automatically and flagged only when something is wrong."

Positioning line. *"We build the operational systems growing UAE businesses are missing (automated lead response, cleaner data, fewer manual hours), installed in weeks and proven with your own numbers before you pay for anything beyond the pilot."*

2. Core services

Six services, sold as one connected system rather than six separate vendors. Each service page shows what the client gets, the delivery steps, the AI's role and why a client should pick Verlyn.

01 CRM setup and lead management

Set up a simple CRM (HubSpot free tier, Zoho or Airtable) so leads stop living in WhatsApp chats, DMs and staff phones.

What the client gets

- Pipeline built around the client's real sales process, not a template.
- WhatsApp, Instagram, website forms and ad leads all landing in one place with an owner assigned.
- Automated follow-up sequences for every lead stage.
- A live view of leads by stage, owner and time-to-first-reply.
- 30-minute team training and a two-week check-in.

How we deliver

1. Map the sales process end to end and mark where leads get lost.
2. Build the CRM structure to match that process.
3. Draft stage-by-stage follow-up sequences with AI.
4. Connect WhatsApp, Instagram and forms into the CRM via Make or Zapier.
5. Train the sales team and review after two weeks of live use.

Where AI does the work

AI designs the lead-scoring logic and writes follow-up sequences from the client's own sales process.

Why choose Verlyn for this

- We start from where you lose leads, not from software features.
- The CRM ships already connected to your ads, website and WhatsApp, so nothing is stitched together by you.
- Role-based logins and written handover, so the system does not depend on one person.
- Proof: leads with no owner and time-to-first-reply, before and after.

02 Landing pages and SEO

Fast, conversion-focused pages (Arabic and English if needed) plus an SEO foundation, for businesses still running on an Instagram-only presence.

What the client gets

- A landing page or small site built in Framer or Webflow, or custom code for special sections.
- Copy, SEO meta tags and target keywords written for the client's real search terms.
- WhatsApp click-to-chat and forms wired straight into the CRM.
- Google Analytics and Search Console connected, mobile speed and broken-link QA done.
- First-two-weeks traffic and enquiry review.

How we deliver

1. Write a content brief and simple sitemap with the client.
2. Draft copy and target keywords with AI.
3. Build in Framer or Webflow, or generate custom sections in code.
4. QA on mobile, page speed and links.
5. Launch, connect analytics and monitor the first two weeks.

Where AI does the work

AI writes site copy and meta tags and generates working code for page sections, cutting build time significantly.

Why choose Verlyn for this

- Every page is built as a lead-capture tool: each visit is tracked to an enquiry in your CRM.
- We report enquiries and cost per lead, not vanity traffic.
- Native-reviewed Arabic alongside English.
- Days to weeks, not months, at SME pricing.

03 Marketing and paid ads

Meta, Google and TikTok campaigns for local SMEs that currently just "boost posts", with content that keeps the ads fed.

What the client gets

- Audit of current spend, funnel and past results.
- Two to three audience personas and multiple ad variants tested against each other.
- Proper UTM tracking so every lead is traced to its ad.
- Weekly optimisation: kill underperformers, scale winners.
- Monthly report in plain English with a clear recommendation.

How we deliver

1. Audit spend, funnel and past ad performance.
2. Build audience personas and draft ad copy variants with AI.
3. Launch with UTM tracking in Meta and Google Ads.
4. Run a weekly optimisation pass.
5. Send a monthly plain-English report.

Where AI does the work

AI drafts ad copy variants for A/B testing and turns raw performance numbers into a readable client report. Content systems (captions, calendars, scripts in the client's brand voice) use the same approach.

Why choose Verlyn for this

- The same team owns the ad, the landing page, the WhatsApp reply and the CRM, so we measure cost per booked appointment, not cost per click.
- No finger-pointing between an ad agency, a web freelancer and a chatbot vendor.
- Reports lead with the number that matters to the owner.
- Concrete, provable claims only in the ad copy we write.

04 Lead generation

A repeatable engine that delivers qualified conversations: targeted outreach, lead-magnet and ad-to-WhatsApp funnels, and automatic qualification before a human ever gets involved.

What the client gets

- Ideal-customer list and a specific, personalised first message built around a gap we noticed in their business.
- LinkedIn and consent-based WhatsApp or email outreach with a working opt-out.
- Ad-to-WhatsApp funnels with an instant qualifying conversation.
- Leads handed over scored, tagged and with context, straight into the CRM.
- Weekly numbers: contacted, replied, qualified, booked.

How we deliver

1. Define the ideal customer and the one gap to lead with.
2. Build the target list and message sequence with AI.
3. Set up the outreach and inbound funnels and connect them to the CRM.
4. Automate first response and qualification questions.
5. Review conversion weekly and refine the message.

Where AI does the work

AI personalises outreach at volume, qualifies inbound leads through conversation and scores them before handover.

Why choose Verlyn for this

- Speed-to-lead: replies in under two minutes, not two days.
- We qualify before we hand over, so your team talks only to real prospects.
- We run this exact engine for ourselves with founder-led outbound, so it is tested before it is sold.
- Priced and reported on cost per qualified lead.

05 Agentic AI

AI agents that do work, not just answer questions. An agent takes a request, uses real tools (calendar, CRM, sheets, email, documents), decides the next step and hands off to a human when unsure.

What the client gets

- One agent scoped to one money-making job, for example: a sales agent that qualifies and books, an operations agent that reads invoices and matches them to purchase orders, a voice receptionist for clinics and salons, or a reporting agent.
- Defined tools and permissions, with human approval required for money and commitments.
- Clear handoff rules and a full activity log.
- A test set of 20+ real scenarios run before go-live.
- Supervised launch, then widened autonomy once results are proven.

How we deliver

1. Pick one workflow with a measurable outcome.
2. Define the tools, permissions and human-handoff rules.
3. Build in n8n or Make, or custom FastAPI code when no-code hits its limit.
4. Test on real scenarios and refine.
5. Go live in supervised mode and review logs weekly.

Where AI does the work

A large language model provides the reasoning and language; the tools give it hands. We connect them and constrain them.

Why choose Verlyn for this

- We ship agents with limits: supervised first, logged, with human handoff, which is what makes an SME owner comfortable saying yes.
- Scoped to a business outcome, not a demo.
- We can write custom backend and frontend code when no-code is not enough; most agencies cannot.
- Arabic and English handling built in.

06 AI automation

Automation with n8n or Make plus AI that removes repeat manual work: WhatsApp and Instagram chatbots, booking, follow-ups, document processing, review requests and reporting.

What the client gets

- WhatsApp and Instagram chatbots that answer FAQs, qualify leads and book appointments.
- Automated review requests and reply drafts, quote generation, invoice and document processing.
- Automated dashboards (Looker Studio or Airtable) with a plain-English monthly summary.
- Documented SOP and a short how-to video.
- Two weeks of monitoring with a response-time report.

How we deliver

1. Discovery call: map lead flow, FAQs and drop-off points.
2. Draft conversation flow and system prompt covering the top 20 customer questions.
3. Build in n8n or Make with the WhatsApp Business API and an AI API (OpenAI or Anthropic).
4. Test with 20+ sample conversations before launch.
5. Deploy on the client's number, connect lead capture to the CRM and monitor for two weeks.

Where AI does the work

AI writes the conversation logic and system prompt and powers the live bot through an API: answering, qualifying, and handing to a human when needed.

Why choose Verlyn for this

- We choose what to automate by hours saved and revenue recovered, then prove it in a small pilot.
- We build it properly and keep it running, unlike DIY tools that get half-configured and abandoned within weeks.
- Documented SOPs and a team behind it, not one freelancer's inbox.
- Every automation has a consent-based opt-in and opt-out step built in from the first build.

3. Why Verlyn is different

The UAE SME automation market is crowded and noisy. Competitors fall into five types, each with a nameable weakness. In a sales call, name the type the prospect is comparing us to.

Competitor type	What they do well	Where they lose SMEs	Our line
Enterprise consultancies	Big-brand comfort, deep specialist bench	6-12 month timelines, six-figure AED minimums, enterprise-style procurement	"Same category of system in weeks, not quarters, at a fraction of the price."
Generic "AI agency" shops	Slick sites, broad service lists	Unverifiable homepage claims; owners are numb to the buzzwords	"We show you a before-and-after number from your own pilot before you pay for anything beyond it."
DIY no-code platforms (ManyChat, Wati, Zoko, Voiceflow)	Low monthly cost, real technology	Owner must become a part-time automation builder; often abandoned within weeks	"We build it, test it and keep it running, so you get the system without becoming the systems person."
Single-function specialists	Good, focused execution in one channel	Three vendors, three invoices, three people to blame	"A chatbot vendor gives you a chatbot. We give you the chatbot connected to the CRM connected to your ad reporting."
Solo freelancers	Cheapest on paper, fast on narrow tasks	No continuity, no documentation, may vanish after go-live	"Documented SOPs, a security review and a team behind it, not one person's inbox."

Head-to-head

	Enterprise	Generic agency	DIY platform	Freelancer	Verlyn Tech
Typical cost	AED 100k+	Opaque	Low subscription	Lowest	Transparent, pilot-first
Time to launch	3-12 months	Weeks-months	As fast as you configure	Days-weeks	Days-weeks
Who builds and maintains	Their team	Their team	You	One person	Verlyn delivery pod
Proof before you pay	Rarely	Homepage stats	You find out	Rarely	Your own pilot numbers
Full-stack coverage	Yes, enterprise scope	Claimed	One tool	One skill	Yes, sized for SMEs
Security built in	Priced in	Rarely mentioned	You configure it	Rarely	Every project
Accountability	Contractual, slow	Varies	Self-service	May vanish	One team, documented SOPs

Six things that make Verlyn different

- **Specialise by industry, not by service.** "The automation team for UAE clinics" beats "a digital agency". Case studies compound inside one community and referrals follow.
- **Show, don't tell.** Lead with a 30-second screen recording of the bot answering a real lead.
- **Numbers, not testimonials.** "Cut response time from 6 hours to 90 seconds" beats any five-star quote.
- **Transparent pricing and a real guarantee.** If response time does not improve in the pilot, you do not pay for the next phase.
- **Founder-led sales for the first 20 clients.** In relationship-driven UAE business, people buy from people.
- **We secure what we build.** Keys, logins and customer data are locked down on every install, a checkable claim generic agencies cannot make.

4. Signature products: what only this startup can build

Services get us the first clients. Products make Verlyn different in kind. Each idea below is a real platform that a small team with FastAPI, React and an LLM API can build, starting as a manually delivered service for 2-3 clients and hardening into software. This is also the answer investors will ask for (see section 7).

Revenue Leak Radar

For: Any SME with leads on WhatsApp, Instagram or ads

Problem: Owners do not know how much money slow replies cost them.

What it does: Connects WhatsApp Business, the CRM and ad accounts, measures time-to-first-reply and drop-off per lead, and shows the result in dirhams: "You lost an estimated AED 38,000 last month to leads answered after 4 hours." One click installs the fix (auto-reply, follow-up, booking).

Why it is different: It sells itself: the audit is the demo. It replaces the paid systems audit with a self-serve product and feeds every service in section 2.

Suggested revenue model: Free scan, then AED 300-800 per month per business.

ClinicFlow: patient-enquiry OS for clinics and wellness

For: Dermatology, dental and wellness clinics

Problem: High ad spend, patients lost between the first WhatsApp message and a booked slot.

What it does: A WhatsApp-first agent that qualifies the enquiry, offers slots from the clinic calendar and confirms bookings; a front-desk dashboard for follow-ups, no-shows and treatment-level conversion; Arabic and English.

Why it is different: Built for one vertical, with clinic-specific flows a generic bot builder does not have. Case studies compound within the clinic community.

Suggested revenue model: Setup fee plus AED 1,500-4,000 per month per clinic.

BrokerDesk: lead-to-viewing engine for small real estate agencies

For: Small and mid-size brokerages

Problem: Leads from portals, ads and WhatsApp are handled manually and fought over.

What it does: Ingests leads from every source, replies instantly, qualifies budget and area, assigns to the right agent, tracks speed-to-lead per agent and re-engages cold leads automatically.

Why it is different: Speed-to-lead accountability per agent is the pain owners feel; a leaderboard sells the product internally.

Suggested revenue model: Per-agent seat pricing, for example AED 150-250 per agent per month.

FreightDesk: quote and document copilot for freight forwarders

For: Logistics and freight SMEs

Problem: Quotes are built by hand from rate sheets over WhatsApp; customs documents are checked manually.

What it does: Generates quotes from uploaded rate sheets, reads invoices, packing lists and certificates with OCR, flags mismatches before submission, and sends automatic shipment-status updates to clients.

Why it is different: B2B, cash-rich and measurable in hours saved and errors avoided; near-zero automation today.

Suggested revenue model: Monthly platform fee plus per-document volume tier.

ProcureFlow: RFQ-to-payment workflow for procurement teams

For: Manufacturing, trading and contracting SMEs

Problem: Supplier quotes live in email; invoice, order and delivery rarely get matched.

What it does: Compiles supplier quotes into a comparison sheet, generates purchase orders through an approval workflow, matches invoice to PO to delivery and flags mismatches, and tracks vendor document expiry.

Why it is different: Three-way matching with an agent that only escalates exceptions; direct ROI in avoided overpayment.

Suggested revenue model: Monthly subscription by number of users or documents.

How to choose the first product. Build the one where two pilot clients already ask for it and where the measured result is a number in dirhams. Revenue Leak Radar is the natural first bet because it is a lead-generation tool for Verlyn and a product at the same time. Price points above are starting hypotheses to test, not validated figures.

5. Tools and pricing

Tool stack by service

Service	Core tools	Skills to master	Cost profile
CRM and lead management	HubSpot (free tier), Zoho CRM, Airtable, Make or Zapier	Sales-process mapping, CRM data models, automation triggers	Free to low subscription; client owns the account
Landing pages and SEO	Framer or Webflow, basic HTML/CSS, Google Analytics 4, Search Console	SEO fundamentals, conversion copy, page speed	Subscription per site
Marketing and paid ads	Meta Ads Manager, Google Ads, TikTok Ads, Canva, CapCut, Looker Studio	Audience testing, UTM tracking, short-form video, copywriting	Ad spend paid by client directly
Lead generation	LinkedIn, WhatsApp Business API, email tools, Make, CRM	Message writing, list building, qualification logic	Low subscription plus WhatsApp message fees
Agentic AI	n8n or Make, an LLM API (Anthropic or OpenAI), Vapi or Retell (voice), FastAPI and React for custom builds	Prompt engineering, tool use, evaluation sets, logging and guardrails	Usage-based API cost, passed through
AI automation	n8n or Make, Zapier, WhatsApp Business API, Voiceflow or Botpress, Google Document AI (OCR)	Workflow design, prompt engineering, testing conversations	Low subscription plus usage-based API cost

Proposed pricing (AED)

These are proposed starting ranges for the first paid clients, set against the value delivered rather than hours worked. Validate them in the first pilots and adjust. Ad spend, WhatsApp fees, software subscriptions and AI API usage are billed at cost to the client and are not included.

Service	One-time setup	Monthly retainer	Notes
CRM setup and lead management	3,500 - 8,000	750 - 1,500	Retainer covers changes, sequences and a monthly review
Landing page	2,500 - 6,000	-	One page, bilingual adds about 30%
Small website + SEO base	6,000 - 12,000	1,500 - 3,500 (SEO)	Retainer is content and ranking work
Paid ads management	1,500 - 2,500 (setup)	2,000 - 4,500	Or 10-15% of ad spend with a minimum
Lead generation	3,000 - 6,000	2,000 - 4,500	Option: price per qualified lead once baseline is known
Agentic AI (one agent)	8,000 - 25,000	1,500 - 4,000	Retainer covers monitoring, tuning and API management
AI automation / WhatsApp bot	4,000 - 10,000	1,000 - 2,500	Includes two weeks of post-launch monitoring
Paid pilot (30 days)	2,500 - 5,000	-	Credited against the first month of a retainer

Packages

Package	What is included	Indicative price
Starter	CRM setup + one landing page + WhatsApp auto-reply	AED 8,000 setup + 1,500 per month
Growth	Starter + paid ads management + lead qualification automation + monthly report	AED 12,000 setup + 4,500 per month
Full system	Growth + agentic AI for one workflow + dashboard + priority support	AED 25,000 setup + 8,000 per month

Pricing rules. Cap free pilots at 3-5 and set the paid-transition trigger before starting. Always use a one-page scope-of-work. Guarantee: if response time does not improve in the pilot, the next phase is free of charge until it does. Convert every proven pilot into a monthly retainer to smooth cash flow.

6. Where to win first, go-to-market and how not to fail

Industry gaps, least to most saturated

- **Clinics, dermatology and wellness:** high spend, weak digital operations.
- **Real estate brokers (small and mid agencies):** leads handled manually on WhatsApp.
- **F&B and restaurants:** ordering, reviews and loyalty automation missing.
- **Logistics, manufacturing and trading SMEs:** near-zero automation, high willingness to pay once ROI is shown.
Fast wins: quote automation, customs-document checks, shipment status updates, reorder alerts, RFQ comparison, PO approval and invoice-to-PO matching.
- **Salons and gyms:** booking and retention automation gap.

Already saturated, so do not lead with these alone: generic social media management and generic web design.

Go-to-market plan

1. Run 3-5 free or heavily discounted pilots for real UAE SMEs from personal networks.
2. Log before-and-after numbers for every project: leads generated, response time, revenue impact. This becomes the entire sales pitch.
3. Build the LinkedIn page around founder stories and client results, not generic agency content.
4. After 3-5 proof-of-work case studies, move to paid retainers.

Ways to reach more UAE businesses

Channel	How to use it
Direct outreach (highest early ROI)	Cold DM, WhatsApp and LinkedIn to SME owners, opening with a specific gap noticed in their business. Someone owns outbound every day.
Local presence	Free zones and coworking spaces (Dubai Internet City, Hub71, Sharjah Media City, in5); business-setup consultants and accountants who onboard new SMEs; GITEX, STEP Conference, Dubai SME events, Sharjah Entrepreneurship Festival.
Institutional channels	Dubai SME, Sharjah SME (Sheraa), ADSME: partner or vendor listings give a trust signal and warm leads.
Content	Short screen-recorded demos as visual proof; Arabic captions as an easy differentiator.
Referrals	Referral incentive for each pilot client who sees results; SME owners talk to each other constantly.

Team structure for 7 people: 2 outbound and sales, 2-3 delivery, 1-2 content and case-study documentation. Document every workflow as an SOP from week one so any of the seven can run a project.

How not to fail

Failure mode	How to avoid it
Serving everyone, no niche	Pick one entry wedge (industry plus service) before expanding; keep case studies in 1-2 verticals.
Free pilots that never convert	Cap at 3-5 and define the paid trigger up front.
No documented process	Write an SOP for each service from week one.
Underpricing from your own cost	Price against the value or ROI delivered.
Scope creep	One-page scope-of-work per project.
Founders doing all delivery	Assign roles across the team early.
Project-only revenue	Convert proven pilots to monthly retainers.
Not tracking client results	Log before and after numbers for every project; they drive renewals and referrals.
Client-facing automation shipped without a safety check	Lock down keys, logins and stored chat data, and build opt-in and opt-out into every messaging flow before go-live.

Minimum definition of success

- **Month 1:** one client (paid or pilot) fully live with a documented before-and-after result.
- **Month 3:** 3-5 case studies with numbers and at least one client converted to a paid retainer.
- **Month 6:** 8-10 paying clients (or a team-set recurring-revenue target) and written SOPs for at least two services.
- **Kill or pivot signal:** if after 3 months no client can point to time or money saved, or nobody will pay even a low price, change the entry wedge (industry or service), not necessarily the company.

7. The pitch

A. Pitching customers (calls and DMs)

30-second pitch. *"We're a UAE-based team that installs the systems most growing businesses are missing, like instant WhatsApp response, automated follow-ups and clean reporting, so you stop losing leads and hours to manual work. We start with one small pilot, show you the before-and-after numbers, and you only scale up from there if it's clearly worth it."*

20-second competitive pitch. *"Most of what's being pitched to you is one of three things: a big consultancy that takes six months and a six-figure invoice, a generic AI agency selling you a percentage from their homepage, or a DIY tool you have to learn to run yourself. We're the team that installs it, proves it with your own numbers in a small pilot, and keeps it running after we leave. You don't pay for the next phase until the first one is obviously worth it."*

Objection	Answer
"We're already talking to a big consultancy."	"Good. Ask them for a working pilot in two weeks. If they can't, that gap is why SMEs come to us."
"We can set up ManyChat or Wati ourselves."	"You can, and most SMEs try that first. We usually get called in after it's been half-configured for three months. We build it properly the first time and keep it running."
"Isn't a freelancer cheaper?"	"Upfront, sometimes. Ask what happens to your customer data and your bot's login if they stop answering messages. That's the gap we close."
"Is this just AI hype?"	"Don't take our word for it. The pilot produces your own before-and-after number before you pay for anything beyond it."

B. Pitching investors

The honest framing. A pure agency is a good business but a weak venture story: revenue scales with headcount. Investors fund a path from services to software. Pitch Verlyn as **productised services heading to a platform**: agency revenue now proves demand and pays for the build; signature products (section 4) create recurring, high-margin revenue later. Do not pitch "an AI agency".

The story in one paragraph

UAE SMEs are 94% of businesses, only 8% are digitally mature, and AI spending is up 105%, but SMEs cannot afford consultants or build it themselves. Verlyn installs the systems that recover lost leads and hours, proves each one with the client's own numbers, and converts pilots into monthly retainers. The services fund and de-risk a product line that sells the same outcomes as software.

Suggested deck (10 slides)

#	Slide	What it must say
1	Title and one-liner	Verlyn Tech: the systems growing UAE businesses are missing, installed in weeks and proven with their own numbers.
2	Problem	SMEs want automation but lack budget and skills (94% SMEs, 8% advanced digital maturity, setup cost and skills gap as top barriers).
3	Solution	Installed growth systems: CRM, landing page, ads, lead generation, agentic AI, automation, sold as one connected system.
4	Demo	30-second screen recording of a bot answering a real lead and the number that changed.
5	Traction	Pilots run, before-and-after numbers, pilot-to-paid conversion, MRR. Show real figures only.
6	Why we win	The five competitor types and our line against each (section 3).
7	Business model	Setup fees, monthly retainers, packages, then platform subscriptions from signature products.
8	Product roadmap	Which signature product comes first (for example Revenue Leak Radar) and what evidence chose it.
9	Go-to-market and team	Founder-led outbound, one-vertical focus, referral engine; who owns sales, delivery and product.
10	The ask	Amount, runway, and what it buys: product build, sales capacity, delivery hires, with milestones.

Metrics investors will look at

- Pilot-to-paid conversion rate and time to convert.
- Monthly recurring revenue and retainer share of total revenue.
- Gross margin per client (target 60-70% after tool and API costs).
- Client retention and expansion (extra services sold to existing clients).
- Cost to acquire a client versus first-year revenue.
- Share of delivery that is templated or automated by Verlyn's own tools.

Illustrative unit economics (assumptions to replace with real data)

Item	Illustration
Blended client	AED 6,000 setup + AED 3,000 per month retainer
Month-6 target	10 paying clients = AED 30,000 monthly recurring revenue, about AED 360,000 annual run-rate
Target gross margin	60-70% after software, API and contractor cost
Year-1 first-client value	$\text{AED } 6,000 + (12 \times \text{AED } 3,000) = \text{AED } 42,000$

Use of funds template: product build 40%, sales and outbound 30%, delivery hires 20%, operations 10%. Set the amount as a team once pilot data exists.

Questions to prepare for

Investor question	Strong answer
"Why is this not just an agency?"	Agency revenue funds discovery; each signature product starts as a service delivered manually to 2-3 clients, then becomes software with recurring pricing.
"What stops a client from using ManyChat or a freelancer?"	Most try that first and abandon it. We sell the outcome, the maintenance and the proof, not the tool.
"What is your moat?"	Vertical case studies and data on what converts in each niche, plus templated flows and products that competitors rebuild from scratch each time.
"What if AI tools make this free?"	The scarce part is deployment, integration and accountability for the result, which cheaper AI increases the demand for.
"Can seven people deliver?"	Defined roles, SOPs for every service, and delivery pods; founder time moves to sales and product as retainers grow.
"Where is the traction?"	Show real pilot numbers. If there are none yet, show the pilot pipeline and say exactly when the first results land.

Avoid: buzzwords, unverified market figures, projections with no assumptions, and claiming traction you do not have.

C. Pitching startup hubs and programs

Targets named in the plan: Hub71 (Abu Dhabi), in5 (Dubai), Sheraa (Sharjah), Dubai Internet City, Sharjah Media City and the government SME programs (Dubai SME, ADSME). Programs differ in what they accept and offer, so check each one's current eligibility, stage and cost before applying, and tailor the application to it.

What hubs generally want to see

- A committed team, with clear roles and time commitment from each founder.
- A real problem in the UAE market, backed by evidence and pilots rather than opinion.
- Early traction: pilots, paying clients or signed letters of intent.
- A credible plan for the next 6-12 months and a reason the hub specifically helps (network, clients, mentors, funding access).
- A contribution back to the ecosystem, such as SME digitisation and job creation.

The five-minute hub pitch

1. **Problem (30 sec):** SMEs are 94% of UAE businesses and only 8% are digitally mature; cost and skills block adoption.
2. **Solution and demo (90 sec):** the 30-second bot demo plus the before-and-after number from a pilot.
3. **Traction (60 sec):** pilots, conversions, first retainers, one named case study.
4. **Plan (60 sec):** one vertical, one entry service, then signature product; the milestones for the program period.
5. **Ask (30 sec):** the specific thing you want from this hub: desk and community, client introductions, mentors, or funding access.

What to bring

- A 60-90 second demo video and a one-page case study with real numbers.
- A 90-day plan with weekly targets (clients, pilots, MRR).
- A one-page team sheet showing who does sales, delivery and product.
- A short list of the hub's own members who fit the ideal customer profile, so the hub sees immediate value.

How to stand out

- Show the productisation path. Hubs and their investors favour startups that are becoming software.
- Be specific about the vertical: "the automation team for UAE clinics" is memorable; "a digital agency" is not.
- Ask for something concrete and measurable, and say how you will use the connection within 30 days.
- Use hub events and member networks as a lead source; a hub that is also a customer channel is worth more than a desk.

Sequence. Run 3-5 pilots and collect real numbers first, then apply to hubs with traction, then take investor meetings with hub backing and revenue. Each step makes the next one easier and the terms better.